Yunyao Zhang

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Profile

I am a PhD student at Huazhong University of Science and Technology, affiliated with the IMCC Lab at HUST. My research focuses on computational social science, neuro-symbolic reasoning, and social network analysis.

Education

Huazhong University of Science and Technology 2024–Present

PhD Student, Intelligent Media Computing and Cybersecurity Laboratory

- Supervisors: Junqing Yu and Zikai Song.

Huazhong University of Science and Technology 2020–2024

B.Eng., School of Cyber Science and Engineering

- Received bachelor's degree in June 2024. Supervisor: Bin Yuan.

Research Interests

Computational Social Science; Neuro-Symbolic Reasoning; Social Network Analysis.

First-Author and Equal-Contribution Publications

Semantic-Aware Logical Reasoning via a Semiotic Framework
Yunyao Zhang, Xinglang Zhang, Junxi Sheng, Wenbing Li, Junqing Yu, Yi-Ping Phoebe Chen, Wei Yang, and Zikai Song.
ACL 2026 Main (CCF-A, Oral, Top 3%) . ACL Anthology; DOI

Logical Phase Transitions: Understanding Collapse in LLM Logical Reasoning
Xinglang Zhang*, **Yunyao Zhang***, ZeLiang Chen, Junqing Yu, Wei Yang, and Zikai Song.
ACL 2026 Main (CCF-A) . ACL Anthology; DOI

GA-S^3: Comprehensive Social Network Simulation with Group Agents
Yunyao Zhang, Zikai Song, Hang Zhou, Wenfeng Ren, Yi-Ping Phoebe Chen, Junqing Yu, and Wei Yang.
Findings of ACL 2025 . ACL Anthology

Coupling Macro Dynamics and Micro States for Long-Horizon Social Simulation
Yunyao Zhang, Yihao Ai, Zuocheng Ying, Qirui Mi, Junqing Yu, Wei Yang, and Zikai Song.
arXiv preprint, 2026. arXiv:2604.05516

IntervenSim: Intervention-Aware Social Network Simulation for Opinion Dynamics
Yunyao Zhang, Zuocheng Ying, Xinglang Zhang, Junqing Yu, Peng Fang, Xu Chen, Wei Yang, and Zikai Song.
arXiv preprint, 2026. arXiv:2604.06600

Seeing Further and Wider: Joint Spatio-Temporal Enlargement for Micro-Video Popularity Prediction
Dali Wang*, **Yunyao Zhang***, Junqing Yu, Yi-Ping Phoebe Chen, Chen Xu, and Zikai Song.
ACM MM 2026 (CCF-A) . arXiv:2604.20311

Surfacing the Unsaid: CUE-Bench for Affective Stance in Chinese Discourse
Zhenyan Zheng*, **Yunyao Zhang***, Junxi Sheng, Junqing Yu, and Zikai Song.
EMNLP 2026 Main (CCF-B / CAAI-A, Oral, Top 3%) . arXiv:2608.10810

* Equal contribution.

Honors and Awards

First Place, ACM Social Media Prediction Challenge 2025 (Video Track), international ranking 2025

National First Prize, The 17th Challenge Cup National Extracurricular Academic Science and Technology Works Competition for College Students 2021

Academic Service

Oral presentation, EMNLP 2026 Main (CUE-Bench) Oct. 2026

Doctoral Forum talk, inaugural China Cyber Security Congress (CCSC 2026) Sep. 2026

Reviewer for ACL, EMNLP, AAAI, and ICLR 2026